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Data management: engaging researchers and crossing disciplines

Experiences @ UK Data Archive

Veerle Van den Eynden
UK Data Archive
Research Data Management Support Services

IASSIST 2010, Ithaca

relu Rural Economy and Land Use Programme
University of Essex
JISC
E·S·R·C ECONOMIC & SOCIAL RESEARCH COUNCIL

Team effort

Research Data Management Support Team @ UK Data Archive:

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What we do

Data management support for researchers

- Advice and guidance
- Training workshops
- Meetings / discussions with researchers
- Review data management plans

UK Data Archive: data preservation and access infrastructure

Identify researchers' data management needs:

- Problems arising at data deposit stage
- Data management plans
- Data sharing survey

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What we do

- Data management planning
  - Rural Economy and Land Use programme (Relu-DSS), 2004-2011
  - Data Management Planning for ESRC Centres and Programmes, 2010-2011

- Data management training workshops
  - Data Management and Sharing Training Programme for social scientists (ESRC Researcher Development Initiative)

www.data-archive.ac.uk/sharing/projects.asp
www.data-archive.ac.uk/relu/

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Evaluate Data Management Planning experiences

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Rural Economy and Land use programme

- Interdisciplinary research programme (2004-2011): social, environmental, biological sciences
- Funding: ESRC, NERC, BBSRC
- Programme data sharing policy:
  - data well managed by researchers
    - project data management plans
    - Relu funds data management support: Relu Data Support Service (Relu-DSS)
  - data archived at the UK Data Archive and Environmental Information Data Centre (EIDC): Research Council funded infrastructure for preserving and sharing data

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Relu data management plans

Data management plan at start of each research project, after funding awarded:

- need for access to existing data sources
- datasets planned to be produced
- planned quality assurance and back-up procedures for data
- plans for management and archiving of collected data
- expected difficulties in making data available for re-use
- measures to overcome such difficulties
- who holds copyright and intellectual property rights of data
- data management roles and responsibilities

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Relu Data Support Service

- Review data management plans – sign off, give advice, request re-write
- Data management information for award holders and grant applicants
- Online guidance on RELU-DSS website and UKDA website
- [Managing and Sharing Data - a best practice guide for researchers]
- Training workshops for researchers
- Project visits to discuss data sharing and management in detail

http://www.data-archive.ac.uk/sharing

Success of data management planning? Relu-DSS view

- Data formats, back-up, storage procedures OK
- Expected difficulties to archive and share data often underestimated, esp. for confidential, commercial or sensitive data
- If difficulties anticipated (ethical / legal), only few suggest solutions
- Failure to gain consent for data sharing, not willingly, but due to unawareness
- Support service needs to give clear and specific advice that researchers understand
- DMP is not necessarily implemented

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Data management challenges

- Data confidentiality and how to archive and share such data:
  - Consent for data sharing
  - Anonymising data
  - Access regulation to data
- Describing and documenting data for re-use
- Data copyright

- Finding time !

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Success of data management planning? Researchers' view

- DMP makes researchers think about and discuss data issues within their project team
- Face-to-face meetings to discuss project-specific data issues and allow Q&A very useful
- Practical advice wanted to be able to plan DM
- DMP needs clear examples / instructions
- Training workshops essential

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Discussion points

- DMP at award application stage or at start of research?
- How ensure data management plan is implemented
- How ensure all researchers in a team are informed / aware?
- Roles for researchers, research support, research funders, data archives?

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What next?

Apply experiences to develop data management planning strategies for ESRC research centres and programmes:

- audit data management practices
- help develop data management planning strategy
- implement DMP strategy and monitor
- training

Collaborating:

- New Dynamics of Ageing (NDA) programme
- Centre for Research on Socio-Cultural Change (CRESC)
- Centre for Social and Economic Research on Innovation in Genomics (Innogen)
- Third Sector Research Centre (TSRC)

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Training workshops, learning materials, best practice guidance

- why and how to share research data
- ethics, consent and confidentiality when sharing research data
- data copyright and the use of existing data resources
- data description, contextualisation and documentation
- data formats and software
- data storage, back-up and security

www.data-archive.ac.uk/sharing/dmstraining.asp

www.data-archive.ac.uk/sharing

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